

DOWNTON FALL RISK INDEX

Assessment of Fall Risk in Adult and Geriatric Inpatients

1. PATIENT IDENTIFICATION

Patient Name: _____

Age / DOB: ____/____/____

MRN / ID: _____

Unit / Ward / Bed: _____

Surgery / Diagnosis: _____

Date / Time: ____/____/____ : ____

FIVE RISK MODULES

Clinical Parameter	Options & Scoring Criteria	Score
1. Previous Falls History of falls within past 12 months	☐ No previous falls in past 12 months (0) ☐ Yes: Has fallen one or more times in past 12 months (1)	[]
2. Medications Prescription of fall-risk drugs (1 pt each category)	☐ None of the listed risk medications taken (0) ☐ Tranquilizers / Sedatives / Hypnotics (1) ☐ Diuretics (1) ☐ Antihypertensive agents (1) ☐ Antiparkinsonian drugs (1) ☐ Antidepressants (1)	[]
3. Sensory Deficits Sensory impairments affecting balance	☐ None: Normal vision, hearing, and limb mobility (0) ☐ Visual impairment / Blindness (1) ☐ Hearing impairment / Deafness (1) ☐ Limb motor weakness / Paralysis / Amputation (1)	[]
4. Mental State Cognitive orientation and awareness	☐ Oriented: Intact awareness of surroundings and limits (0) ☐ Confused / Disoriented / Wandering / Impulsive (1)	[]
5. Ambulation / Gait Walking stability and gait quality	☐ Normal: Safe walking, normal steady stride (0) ☐ Safe with walking aid (cane, walker, crutches) (1) ☐ Unsafe with or without walking aid (1) ☐ Unable to walk / Completely bedbound (0)	[]

TOTAL SCORE: [] POINTS (Maximum: 14 points (Risk if > **Assessor (RN / License #):** _____
2))

CLINICAL INTERPRETATION & RECOMMENDED NURSING ACTIONS

Low Fall Risk (0 - 2 points)

Standard universal fall precautions, call light within reach, safe non-skid footwear.

High Fall Risk (> 2 points)

High fall protocol: yellow armband, bed alarm, assisted toileting schedule, supervised transfers.

Registered Nurse (RN) Signature & Professional Stamp

Date & Time of Assessment